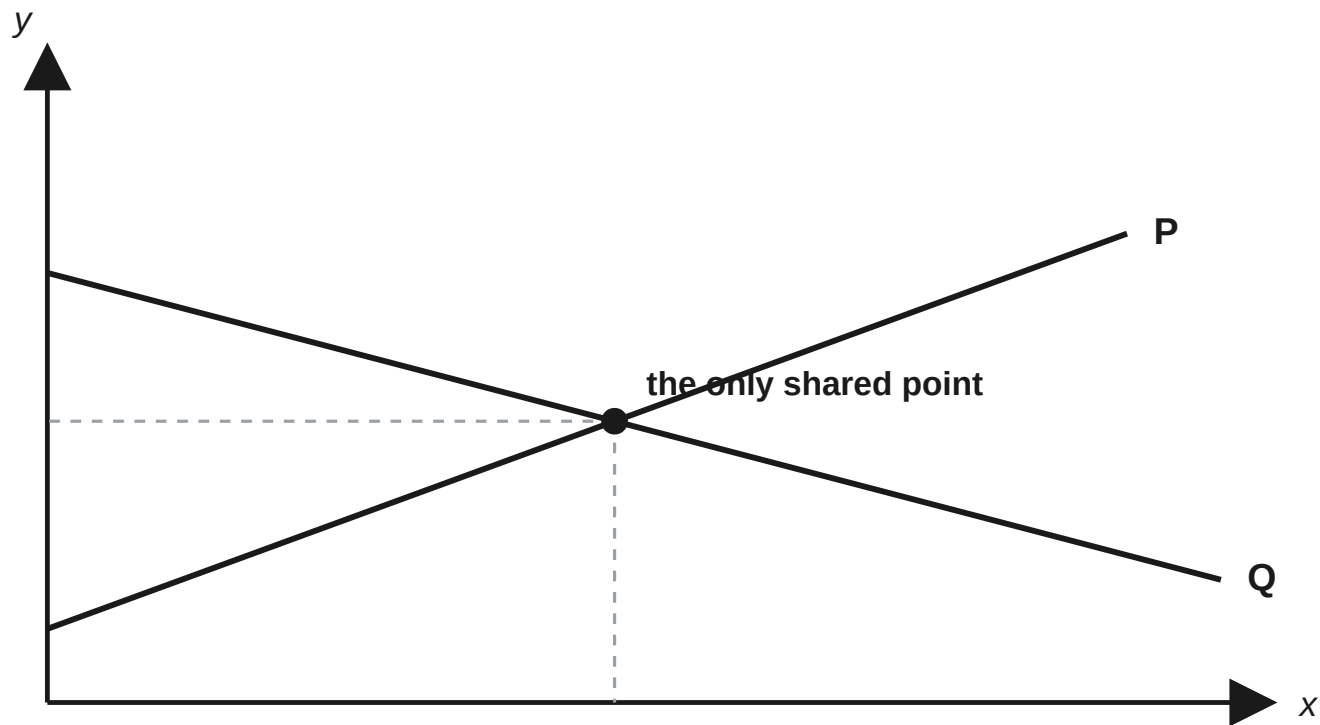


Two distinct lines (degree 1) cross at most once



Two distinct degree-1 polynomials agree on at most 1 point; agreeing on 2 or more would force $P = Q$.

In general two distinct polynomials of degree below d agree on fewer than d points.